English Communication & Engineering Career Skills (ECECS) UESTC2029 / UESTCHN2005

Lecture 1: Course introduction & key skills

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& the English language teaching team

Lecture 1 Aims

- introduce the course and requirements
- highlight the key skills for course success
- contextualise the course as a tool for career development

ECECS: Course overview

Learning outcomes

- **Search for**, **evaluate** and **select** relevant information from printed and online resources
- **Produce** clear and concise technical documents/reports using appropriate, discipline-specific language, style and referencing conventions
- **Deliver** oral presentations of a technical nature, incorporating effective visual aids
- **Produce** relevant and appropriate written and spoken information for job seeking, incorporating Equality, Diversity and Inclusion (EDI) principles
- **Interact** effectively in an interview context
- **Work effectively in a team** on a literature-based research task
- **Analyse** issues related to the **Grand Challenges** in engineering

Detailed course specifications are on Moodle

Course overview: Content

weeks	focus	coverage
1 - 7	Employability & academic skills	CVs & cover letters, interview skills, finding and evaluating sources
7-11	Academic writing skills	Technical reports, academic language development Abstracts for lab reports & other academic articles
13-16	Presentation skills & exam	Focus on communication & engagement, working with a non-specialist audience, final exam preparation, further writing work

See Student Handbook on Moodle for further info

Assessment overview

Assessment	Weighting
Portfolio	10%
Written assignment	20%
Oral assessment and presentation	30%
Written exam	40%

Assessment overview

Course Assessment Rules & Information

- You must complete all the assessments to meet the course requirements
- There is **no resit** opportunity for the **portfolio** and **group interview** (which means you can't be awarded a grade for the course without completing these first time)
- To meet progression rules you must achieve grade **D3** in the **written exam**, **written assignment, oral assessment & presentation**
- Each assessment is part of a simulation (see Lecture 3)
- You will be given details of the assessment criteria in advance of each task

How you are assessed

UofG Grade	UofG Point	UESTC%
A1	22	99
A2	21	95
A3	20	92
A4	19	89
A5	18	86
B1	17	82
B2	16	79
B3	15	76
C1	14	72
C2	13	69
C3	12	66
D1	11	64
D2	10	62
D3	9	60
E1	8	57
E2	7	52
E3	6	47
F1	5	42
F2	4	37
F3	3	32
G1	2	26
G2	1	18
H	0	7

Your grades

Primary Grade	Descriptor
A	Exemplary range and depth of attainment of intended learning outcomes, secured by discriminating command of a comprehensive range of relevant materials and analyses, and by deployment of considered judgement relating to key issues, concepts and procedures
B	Conclusive attainment of virtually all intended learning outcomes, clearly grounded on a close familiarity with a wide range of supporting evidence, constructively utilised to reveal appreciable depth of understanding
C	Clear attainment of most of the intended learning outcomes, some more securely grasped than others, resting on a circumscribed range of evidence and displaying a variable depth of understanding
D	Acceptable attainment of intended learning outcomes, displaying a qualified familiarity with a minimally sufficient range of relevant materials, and a grasp of the analytical issues and concepts which is generally reasonable, albeit insecure
E	Attainment deficient in respect of specific intended learning outcomes, with mixed evidence as to the depth of knowledge and weak deployment of arguments or deficient manipulations
F	Attainment of intended learning outcomes appreciably deficient in critical respects, lacking secure basis in relevant factual and analytical dimensions
G	Attainment of intended learning outcomes markedly deficient in respect of nearly all intended learning outcomes, with irrelevant use of materials and incomplete and flawed explanation
H	No convincing evidence of attainment of intended learning outcomes, such treatment of the subject as is in evidence being directionless and fragmentary

Course Moodle

https://moodle.gla.ac.uk/course/view.php?id=53147

The “S” in ECECS - what do we mean by ‘skills’?

- **21st Century skills**
- ***Independent* skills**
- **Transferable skills**
- **Graduate attributes**
- **IET**
- **Engineering councils**

How will you stand out from the crowd?

Some of the skills and qualities you will need include:

- Teamwork
- Decision-making
- Communicating complex ideas to both technical and lay audiences
- Problem-solving
- Project and budget management

Graduate Attributes Task 2.1

Reasons

- Stand out from crowd
- Extracurricular skills
- For CV – stand out
- Managing projects – put into practice

Graduate Attributes

- Confidence
- Working in a team, leading a team, making decisions
- Able to communicate different ideas
- Problem solving
- How to budget; events management
- Not just degree results, tangible
- Grow as person – on CV, in life

Engineering Council

The UK Standard for Professional Engineering Competence and Commitment (UK-SPEC)

Fourth edition

A professional's ability to carry out engineering tasks successfully and safely within their field of practice

For the Engineering Council, this involves demonstrating:

A. Knowledge and understanding
B. Design, development and solving engineering problems
C. Responsibility, management and leadership
D. Communication and interpersonal skills
E. Professional Commitment

Competence		Examples of evidence
D. Communication and interpersonal skills **Chartered Engineers shall demonstrate effective communication and interpersonal skills.** This is the ability to work with others constructively, to explain ideas and proposals clearly and to discuss issues objectively and constructively.	The applicant shall demonstrate that they: 1. Communicate effectively with others, at all levels, in English	• Preparing reports, drawings, specifications and other documentation on complex matters • Leading, chairing, contributing to and recording meetings and discussions • Exchanging information and providing advice to technical and non-technical colleagues • Engaging or interacting with professional networks
	2. Clearly present and discuss proposals, justifications and conclusions	• Contributing to scientific papers or articles as an author • Preparing and delivering presentations on strategic matters • Preparing bids, proposals or studies • Identifying, agreeing and leading work towards collective goals
	3. Demonstrate personal and social skills and awareness of diversity and inclusion issues.	• Knowing and managing own emotions, strengths and weaknesses • Being confident and flexible in dealing with new and changing interpersonal situations • Identifying, agreeing and working towards collective goals

Institute of Engineering & Technology (IET) Accreditation & AHEP 4

Engineering analysis | **The Engineer & Society** | **Engineering practice**

C4 Technical literature: Select and evaluate technical literature and other sources of information to address complex problems.

C7 Sustainability: Evaluate the environmental and societal impact of solutions and minimise adverse impacts.

C11 EDI: Adopt an inclusive approach to engineering practice and recognise the responsibilities, benefits and importance of supporting equality, diversity and inclusion.

C16 Teamwork: Function effectively as an individual and as a member or leader of a team.

C17 Communication: Communicate effectively on complex engineering matters with technical and non-technical audiences.

C18 Lifelong learning: Plan and record self-learning and development as the foundation of lifelong learning/CPD.

Making the most of this course: study skills

- Take notes (by hand!)
- Review your notes
- Ask questions (in class, in lectures, on forums)
- Be ‘present’ and participate fully in classes and lectures
- Work on vocabulary development
- Watch the video guides
- Pay attention to detail: proofread all your work carefully
- Use AI as an *assistant* for writing and research – **not** as a substitute for your own skill development.

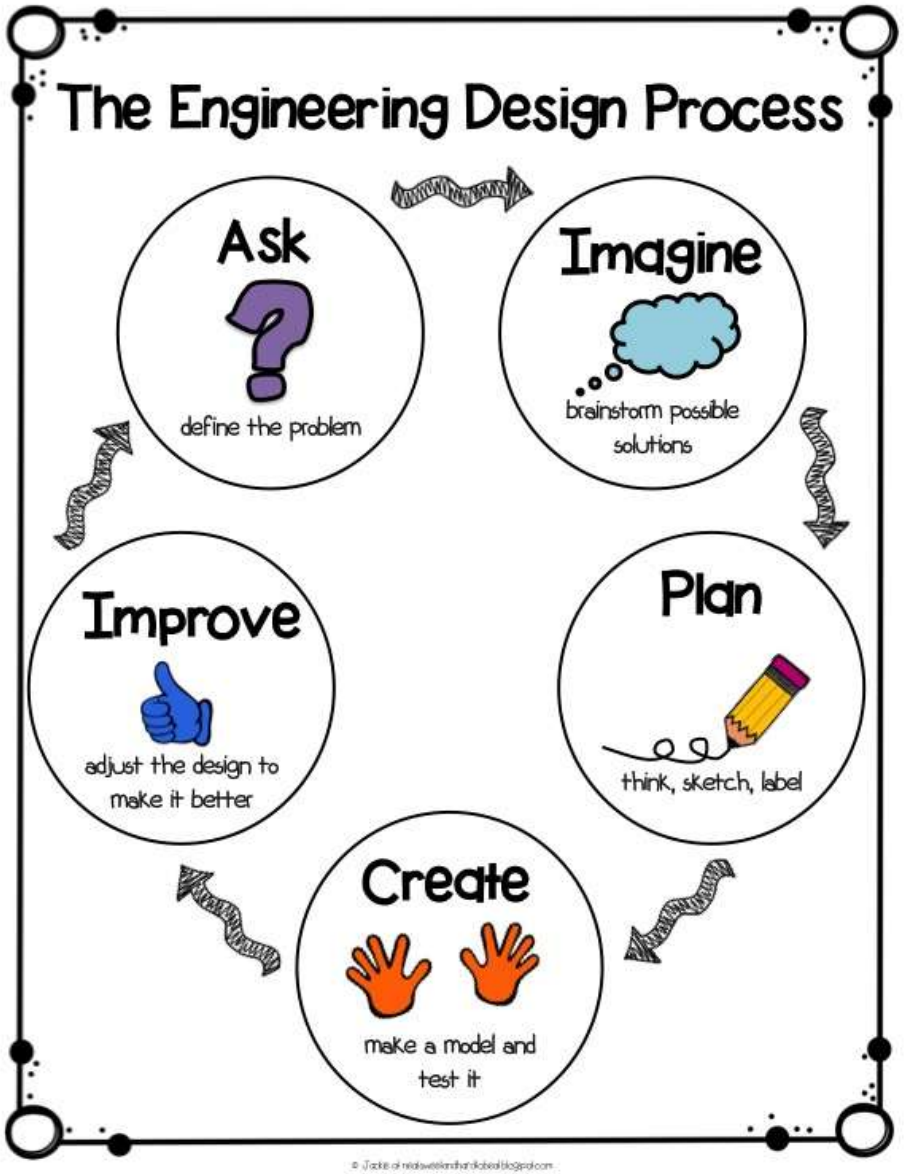
Maja van der Velden, professor of digitalisation at Oslo, found that most students who took lecture notes by hand reported having ‘better recall, being less distracted, feeling more creative and, overall, experiencing a deeper connection with their work.’

Students said they were more likely to write down exactly what a lecturer said when using a computer, whereas handwriting forced them to summarise what they had heard in their own words, which is associated with better memory and understanding.

https://www.timeshighereducation.com/news/writing-lecture-notes-hand-creates-deeper-understanding accessed 20 Feb 2021

See Week 1 Resources

Making the most of this course: study skills



English Communication & Engineering Career Skills

Lecture 2:
CVs and Cover Letters

Dr Neil McMillan,
University of Glasgow

Aims

- Introduce a range of CV types
- Understand the basic content and layout of CVs
- Learn why employers require cover letters
- Develop language skills in CV and cover letter writing.

1. An introduction to CVs/Résumés

"I want my résumé to be the one you remember!"

Note: you will do more work on this in CS 3

Task 1.1 Getting started

- What does the abbreviation ‘CV’ stand for?
- Is there only one type of CV?
- Is there a standard structure for a CV? What sections should you include?
- Which two parts of a CV can be moved around?
- How long should a CV be?

Curriculum Vitae (CV)

Course of one's life

USA: Résumé

Summary

- **Bucket**
- Speculative
- **Student**
- Graduate
- Technical
- Academic

3 main types:

- Chronological
- Skills-based
- Hybrid

Bucket CV

Personal Details

Name
Contact Details
Nationality
Social Media (eg Linkedin, Wechat)

(career objective)

Education (chronological – most recent first)

Date	Course(s)	Institution	Grades

Work experience (most recent first, paid and unpaid, sector and non-sector)

Date
Job Title/Description of Role
Employer (name of organisation)
Achievements/Responsibilities

Skills (add categories if you have some you wish to remember/include)

-
-

Task 1.2 Vocabulary

chronological *(adj)*
hard skills / soft skills *(n)*
cherry-pick *(v)*
skeleton *(noun + adj)*

Task 1.2 Video Notetaking

Watch the University of Glasgow Video. We will play the video in sections. Section 1 (**0.00 – 2.24**).

Focus your notes on the following:

- What to do before you start writing a CV
- How to structure or organise your CV
- What to add to your ‘skeleton structure’
- Layout of your CV

University of Glasgow

VIA VERITAS VITA

Play (k)

0:00 / 11:27

Task 1.2 Video Notetaking (FB)

What to do before you start writing a CV

- Visualise person you are writing to; tell about yourself, experience, match job criteria, why hire you

How to structure or organise your CV

- Normally in chronological order and/or in order of relevance to your reader

What to add to your 'skeleton structure'

- Essential and desirable competencies
- Degree, extracurricular, work experience, hard skills (e.g. languages)

Curriculum Vitae (CV)

Layout

- Name & contact details
- Career objectives
- Education
- Relevant/sector experience
- Other employment
- Skills and achievements
- References

(education and relevant experience can be swapped)

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VIA VERITAS VITA

Play (k)

0:00 / 11:27

Task 1.3: Video – More Notes

To convince the reader you have the skills and experience to do the job, use the CAR technique in each section of your CV:

Context	When did you do it? Where did you do it? Who was involved?
Action	What did you do?
Reason **Relevance** **Result**	Why have you included it? What skills or competences have you demonstrated as a result?

Be specific, use quantitative and qualitative evidence, and persuasive language

Task 1.3 Video – more notes: other info

Education

- Match evidence to job descriptions
- Projects, field trips, study abroad
- Modules specific to job

Prospects (transferable skills) https://www.prospects.ac.uk/

Skills for your CV

In the course of your degree, you develop subject-specific skills in areas such as designing and testing circuit building blocks, computer programming and computer-aided design. You also develop other transferable skills including:

- the ability to use specialist knowledge creatively and innovatively to solve problems
- pragmatism and practicality to turn a concept into reality
- effective communication (spoken and written)
- good teamworking
- project and time management
- a professional approach and ability to work to an ethical code of conduct.

These skills help electrical and electronic engineers to be in demand in other sectors, such as finance and management.

Go to Mentimeter …

Which verbs do you think are most effective in a CV?

Task 1.4 Powerful verbs

achieved, boosted, chaired, designed, engineered, facilitated, generated, handled, identified, implemented, joined, launched, led, managed, networked, organised, participated, revised, secured, transformed, updated, validated, worked on

- These *action* verbs show what you have done/succeeded in doing.
- Choose the verbs that demonstrate your actions in the most impactful way (without exaggerating!)

More advice on language for CVs

- Choose words carefully
- Don’t include basic expectations of a student/graduate like: *I enjoy a challenge, I am good at meeting deadlines*
- Don’t use ‘over the top’ language: *I have the greatest innovative mindset*
- Don’t put in too much detail
- Be economical with language (concise)
- Use phrases and bullet points, not long sentences
- Don’t overuse ‘I’
- Review, proofread and edit

achieved, boosted, chaired, designed, engineered, facilitated, generated, handled, identified, implemented, joined, launched, led, managed, networked, organised, participated, revised, secured, transformed, updated, validated, worked on

2. Cover letters

Dear Sir/Madam...
Dear Potential Customer...
Dear fellow citizen...
Dear friend...
Mon ami...
Hey you gorgeous thing, you...
Dude...

Task 2.1 Reason for cover letters

Why do employers ask for cover letters?

- A cover letter is a short introduction to you and your CV
- It helps convince the employer to look at your CV
- It shows your writing and communication skills
- It allows you to show how you are unique and that you are enthusiastic for the job.

Task 2.2 Dos and Don’ts

True or False

1. ‘To whom it may concern’ or ‘Dear Sir/Madam’ are the best ways to address the person you are writing to. ✗
2. You should say why you didn’t/don’t like your previous/current position. ✗
3. You shouldn’t include everything in your cover letter that is in your CV. ✓
4. The cover letter should only be one page long. ✓
5. You should use the same cover letter for every post you apply for. ✗
6. It is a good idea to ask someone else to check/proofread your cover letter. ✓

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VIA VERITAS VITA

Play (k)

0:00 / 11:27

Task 2.3: Video and notetaking

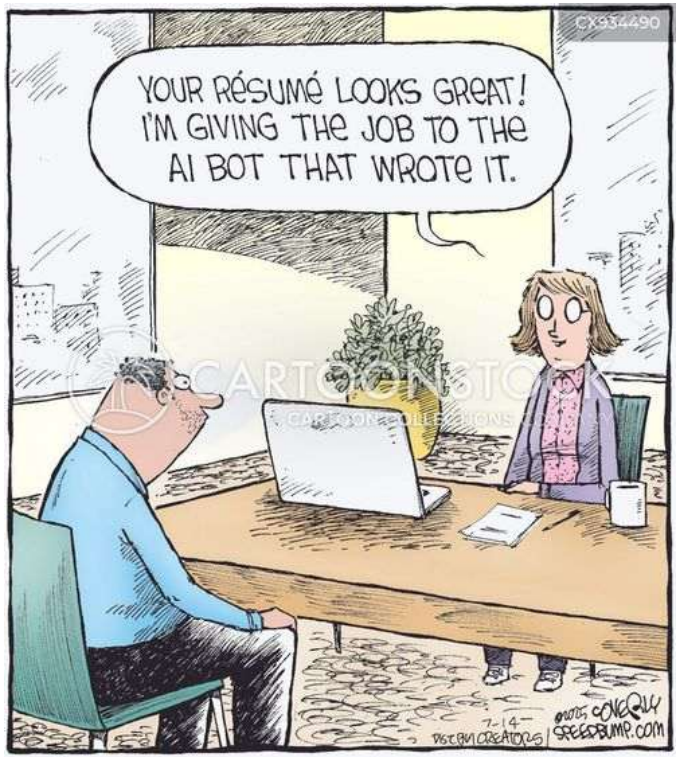
In a cover letter, you should:

Describe the job you are applying for	Name of organisation and title of job, any reference quoted in the advert and, perhaps, where you saw the job advertised
Explain why you want this job	Research the employer and job, make it clear why you want to work for the employer and in this job
Explain why the organisation should employ you	Describe what you will bring to the organisation and post with explicit reference to the job description and person specification, providing evidence for your statements
End on a positive note	Show enthusiasm, say you are looking forward to an interview, sign off appropriately

Additional advice

Don't

- Exaggerate or over-state your experience
- Beg for the job
- Use clichés
- Use an AI generated letter



Out-of-class work

Homework:

- Read the information again on the course and its assessment. If you have any questions, make a note of these to ask your class teacher or your lecturer.
- Start to create a ‘bucket/skeleton CV’. Bring your draft to CS 3.
- See **Task 2.1** in CS 3 and complete this before the session.
- Send a message on the Lecturer forum to say hello and make any comments/ask questions.

Extra work:

- Watch the video from the University of Glasgow again.